

GED Social Studies Practice Test 3

PART A — QUESTIONS

GED-SOC3-001

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state constitution allows citizens to request government records such as meeting minutes, agency budgets, and contracts. The law also allows officials to withhold certain records, such as private medical information or details of an ongoing criminal investigation. Supporters say the law helps residents evaluate how public money is spent while still protecting sensitive information.

Which statement best describes the purpose of this type of law?

- A) It gives courts the power to write agency budgets.
- B) It helps citizens monitor government while balancing privacy and security concerns.
- C) It allows public officials to cancel elections during investigations.
- D) It requires all private businesses to publish employee records.

GED-SOC3-002

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A small business recorded worker output before and after buying new equipment.

Month: March, April

Workers: 10, 10

Units produced: 1,200, 1,500

Which conclusion is best supported by the table?

- A) Productivity increased after the new equipment was purchased.
- B) The number of workers doubled after the new equipment was purchased.
- C) Production decreased from March to April.
- D) The equipment had no effect because the number of workers stayed the same.

GED-SOC3-003

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

In the early 1800s, the United States warned European powers not to create new colonies in the Western Hemisphere. U.S. leaders argued that the nations of the Americas should not be controlled by European monarchies. The policy also showed that the United States wanted a stronger role in the region.

Which foreign policy idea is best reflected in this source?

- A) The United States sought to limit European influence in the Americas.
- B) The United States wanted to return to British colonial rule.
- C) The United States supported new European colonies in North America.
- D) The United States ended all contact with Latin American countries.

GED-SOC3-004

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A country has dry northern plains, rainy coastal lowlands, and mountains in the west. Most large cities developed near the coast, where ports, mild temperatures, and access to trade routes made transportation easier.

Which factor best explains the pattern of settlement?

- A) Physical geography influenced where people built major cities.
- B) Mountain areas always have the highest population density.
- C) Trade routes have no effect on settlement patterns.
- D) Cities develop randomly, without regard to climate or transportation.

GED-SOC3-005

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

A state passes a law requiring professional licenses for certain health workers. A group challenges the law, arguing that the licensing rules are unfair. The state responds that protecting public health is one of its reserved powers.

Which TWO statements best connect this scenario to federalism?

- A) States may use reserved powers to regulate public health and safety.
- B) Federalism divides power between national and state governments.
- C) State laws automatically override every federal law.
- D) Federalism means only local governments may regulate health workers.
- E) The Constitution gives state governments power to declare war.

GED-SOC3-006

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A person questioned by police says that they do not want to answer questions without an attorney present. The officer stops the questioning until the person can speak with a lawyer. The officer explains that the legal system protects people from being forced to provide evidence against themselves.

Which constitutional protection is most directly connected to this situation?

- A) Protection against self-incrimination
- B) Right to quarter soldiers
- C) Power of Congress to regulate trade
- D) Power of states to appoint ambassadors

GED-SOC3-007

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

During the mid-1800s, many settlers moved westward after the federal government offered land to people willing to farm it. Supporters believed the policy would encourage settlement and economic growth. Critics noted that westward expansion often displaced Native peoples and increased conflict over land.

Which statement best summarizes the historical significance of this policy?

- A) It encouraged western settlement while contributing to conflict over land.
- B) It ended all migration to the western territories.
- C) It prevented farming from expanding beyond the Atlantic coast.
- D) It gave Native nations full control over federal land policy.

GED-SOC3-008

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

The Tenth Amendment is most closely connected to [D1] because it reserves certain powers to [D2].

Dropdowns:

D1) federalism | judicial review | naturalization

D2) the states or the people | foreign governments | federal courts only

GED-SOC3-009

Section: Social Studies

Type: numeric_entry

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A city sales tax is 6%. A resident buys a \$250 appliance. How many dollars of sales tax will the resident pay?

Type your answer as a dollar amount without the dollar sign.

GED-SOC3-010

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A coastal fishing community depends on nearby waters for jobs and food. After fish populations decline, officials limit the number of fish that boats may catch each season. Some fishers object because the limits reduce income in the short term. Scientists argue that the limits may help fish populations recover.

Which conclusion is best supported by this scenario?

- A) Resource management can involve short-term costs and long-term environmental goals.
- B) Fishing communities are not affected by environmental change.
- C) Natural resources never require regulation.
- D) Scientists and workers always agree about economic policy.

GED-SOC3-011

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

A committee in Congress investigates whether a federal agency used public funds properly. Agency officials must testify and provide documents. The committee cannot run the agency directly, but it can hold hearings and recommend changes to the law.

Which congressional power is most directly shown?

- A) Oversight of the executive branch
- B) Command of state militias
- C) Appointment of Supreme Court justices
- D) Ratification of state constitutions

GED-SOC3-012

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A table shows changes in railroad mileage in a region.

Year: 1860, 1880, 1900

Railroad miles: 1,800, 7,200, 12,600

Which statement is best supported by the table?

- A) Railroad mileage decreased after 1860.
- B) Railroad mileage increased substantially between 1860 and 1900.
- C) Railroad mileage was the same in 1880 and 1900.
- D) The region had no railroad lines in 1860.

GED-SOC3-013

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

Every ten years, the federal government counts the population. The results help determine how many seats each state receives in the House of Representatives. Population changes can cause some states to gain seats while others lose seats.

Which purpose of the census is described?

- A) Apportioning representation in the House
- B) Selecting federal judges
- C) Ratifying constitutional amendments
- D) Declaring war

GED-SOC3-014

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A company can produce either 100 bicycles or 40 scooters each week using the same workers and equipment. The owner chooses to produce bicycles because demand for bicycles has increased.

What does the company give up by choosing bicycles?

- A) The opportunity to produce scooters with those same resources
- B) The need to pay workers
- C) The ability to sell any product
- D) The rule that prices change when demand changes

GED-SOC3-015

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A president nominates a person to serve on the Supreme Court. Before the nominee can take the position, the Senate holds hearings and votes on whether to confirm the nominee.

Which principle is most directly illustrated?

- A) Checks and balances
- B) Direct democracy
- C) Popular referendum
- D) State nullification

GED-SOC3-016

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

During World War II, many factories shifted from producing consumer goods to producing military equipment. Women and African Americans entered industrial jobs in larger numbers, though

discrimination continued. The federal government also encouraged citizens to buy war bonds and conserve materials.

Which TWO conclusions are best supported by this description?

- A) The war effort changed labor patterns in the United States.
- B) The federal government encouraged civilian participation in the war effort.
- C) Wartime production ended the need for factories.
- D) Discrimination disappeared immediately during World War II.
- E) The United States refused to mobilize its economy for war.

GED-SOC3-017

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A region reports the following land use.

Land use: Forest, Cropland, Urban areas, Desert

Share of land: 38%, 27%, 15%, 20%

Which land use covers the largest share of the region?

- A) Forest
- B) Cropland
- C) Urban areas
- D) Desert

GED-SOC3-018

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A newspaper publishes an editorial criticizing a proposed state law. The editorial urges readers to contact their representatives before the vote. The article does not threaten violence or publish private personal data.

Which constitutional principle is most directly connected to this example?

- A) Freedom of the press and political expression
- B) Power of Congress to admit new states
- C) Right of states to sign treaties
- D) Requirement that the president be at least 35 years old

GED-SOC3-019

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A county reports the following unemployment data.

Year: 2020, 2021, 2022

Unemployed workers: 9,600, 7,800, 6,500

Which conclusion is best supported by the data?

- A) The number of unemployed workers decreased each year.
- B) The number of unemployed workers increased each year.
- C) The number of unemployed workers stayed the same.
- D) Unemployment was highest in 2022.

GED-SOC3-020

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

In presidential elections, voters in each state help choose electors. The body that formally selects the president is called the [D1], and each state's number of electors is based mainly on its [D2].

Dropdowns:

D1) Electoral College | Cabinet | Supreme Court

D2) total number of senators and representatives | number of county governments | number of public universities

GED-SOC3-021

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A state has 12 representatives in the U.S. House and 2 U.S. senators.

How many electoral votes does the state have?

- A) 10
- B) 12
- C) 14
- D) 24

GED-SOC3-022

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Paired sources:

Source A:

A senator in 1941 argues that the United States should avoid entering foreign wars. The senator says the nation should defend its own shores, build its military, and protect its economy, but should not send soldiers to fight overseas unless directly attacked. The senator warns that foreign conflicts can drain resources and reduce freedom at home.

Source B:

A newspaper editorial in 1941 argues that events overseas already threaten American security. The editorial says that if aggressive powers control Europe and Asia, the United States will face greater danger later. It supports aid to nations resisting aggression and says that waiting too long may make war harder to avoid.

What is the main disagreement between the two sources?

- A) Whether the United States should remain isolated or take a more active role in world affairs
- B) Whether the United States had a military before 1941
- C) Whether newspapers should be allowed to discuss foreign policy
- D) Whether Congress should abolish the presidency during wartime

GED-SOC3-023

Section: Social Studies

Type: numeric_entry

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A region's population increased from 2,500,000 to 3,000,000 over twenty years. What was the percent increase?

Type your answer as a whole number percent without the percent sign.

GED-SOC3-024

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A court rules that a city may not punish a religious group simply because city officials dislike the group's beliefs. The court explains that government may not favor or target religious beliefs without a valid constitutional reason.

Which constitutional idea is most closely connected to the ruling?

- A) Free exercise of religion and government neutrality toward religion
- B) The power to regulate interstate commerce
- C) The right of states to create money
- D) The president's role as commander in chief

GED-SOC3-025

Section: Social Studies

Type: drag_drop

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Match each target with the correct tile.

Tiles:

- A) Reserved powers
- B) Enumerated powers
- C) Concurrent powers
- D) Implied powers

Targets:

- T1) Powers specifically listed for the federal government in the Constitution
- T2) Powers kept by the states or the people
- T3) Powers shared by both national and state governments

GED-SOC3-026

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A family creates a monthly budget. They set aside money first for rent, food, utilities, and transportation. After those expenses, they decide how much to save and how much to spend on entertainment.

Which statement best explains the purpose of the budget?

- A) It helps the family plan how to use limited income.
- B) It guarantees that prices will never increase.
- C) It allows the family to avoid all taxes.
- D) It replaces the need for financial choices.

GED-SOC3-027

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A new law is published before it takes effect. Citizens can read the law, courts can review how it is applied, and officials must follow the same legal procedures that apply to everyone else.

Which civic principle is most clearly described?

- A) Rule of law
- B) Hereditary power
- C) Military rule
- D) Unlimited executive authority

GED-SOC3-028

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

In the 1970s, a political scandal led to investigations, court cases, and congressional hearings. The controversy raised questions about executive power, the use of government agencies, and whether a president could withhold evidence from investigators. The events increased public attention to accountability in government.

Which broader issue is most clearly shown by this source?

- A) Limits on executive power and the importance of accountability
- B) The beginning of westward expansion

- C) The creation of the first political parties
- D) The end of all congressional investigations

GED-SOC3-029

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A landlocked country exports minerals but has no direct access to the ocean. To reach world markets, it relies on railroads and highways that cross neighboring countries to reach seaports.

Which geographic challenge is most clearly described?

- A) Limited direct access to maritime trade routes
- B) Too many natural harbors
- C) Lack of any transportation needs
- D) Complete independence from neighboring countries

GED-SOC3-030

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A public survey asked residents which issue the city council should discuss first.

Issue: Street lighting, Recycling, Bus routes, Park safety

Responses: 240, 180, 310, 270

How many total residents responded to the survey?

- A) 760
- B) 900
- C) 1,000
- D) 1,110

GED-SOC3-031

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A citizen receives a summons to appear as a witness in court. The citizen attends the hearing and gives truthful testimony under oath.

Which responsibility is the citizen fulfilling?

- A) Participating in the legal process when required
- B) Appointing federal judges
- C) Declaring a law unconstitutional
- D) Negotiating a foreign treaty

GED-SOC3-032

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

A county reports voter turnout by precinct.

Precinct: North, East, South, West

Registered voters: 4,000, 3,500, 5,000, 2,500

Ballots cast: 2,400, 1,750, 3,000, 1,250

Which TWO statements are supported by the data?

- A) North and South had the same turnout rate.
- B) East had more ballots cast than North.
- C) West had a turnout rate of 50%.
- D) South had the fewest registered voters.
- E) North had 4,000 ballots cast.

GED-SOC3-033

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

Before a bill becomes law, it is debated in committee, amended, voted on by both chambers of the legislature, and sent to the executive for approval or veto. Supporters say the process can be slow, but it gives different representatives chances to review the proposal.

Which statement best explains why this process matters?

- A) Lawmaking procedures can slow decisions but encourage review and accountability.
- B) Laws become valid only when courts write them.
- C) Legislatures are not involved in making laws.
- D) The executive branch may permanently cancel all legislative debate.

GED-SOC3-034

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A table shows voter registration in one Southern county before and after a civil rights campaign.

Year: 1960, 1966

Registered voters: 4,200, 11,700

By how many people did voter registration increase?

- A) 4,200
- B) 7,500

- C) 11,700
- D) 15,900

GED-SOC3-035

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A state court orders a public agency to stop enforcing a regulation because the agency created the rule without following the required public notice and comment process.

Which conclusion is best supported by this decision?

- A) Government agencies must follow lawful procedures when creating regulations.
- B) Agencies may ignore procedures when they disagree with citizens.
- C) Courts have no role in reviewing agency action.
- D) Public notice is required only for private businesses.

PART B — ANSWER KEY + EXPLANATIONS

GED-SOC3-001 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: It helps citizens monitor government while balancing privacy and security concerns. — Explanation: The source describes public access to records while allowing limits for sensitive information.

GED-SOC3-002 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Productivity increased after the new equipment was purchased. — Explanation: The same number of workers produced more units, so output per worker increased.

GED-SOC3-003 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: The United States sought to limit European influence in the Americas. — Explanation: The source describes a policy warning European powers against new colonies in the Western Hemisphere.

GED-SOC3-004 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Physical geography influenced where people built major cities. — Explanation: Coastal access, ports, climate, and trade routes helped shape the settlement pattern.

GED-SOC3-005 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: States may use reserved powers to regulate public health and safety. | Federalism divides power between national and state governments. — Explanation: The scenario involves state police powers within a system that divides authority between levels of government.

GED-SOC3-006 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Protection against self-incrimination — Explanation: The person is protected from being forced to provide evidence against themselves.

GED-SOC3-007 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: It encouraged western settlement while contributing to conflict over land. — Explanation: The source says the policy promoted settlement but also displaced Native peoples and increased land conflict.

GED-SOC3-008 — Correct: D1=federalism; D2=the states or the people — Correct Answer: D1=federalism; D2=the states or the people — Explanation: The Tenth Amendment reserves powers not delegated to the federal government to the states or the people.

GED-SOC3-009 — Correct: 15 — Tolerance: exact — Correct Answer: 15 — Explanation: 6% of \$250 is $0.06 \times 250 = 15$.

GED-SOC3-010 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Resource management can involve short-term costs and long-term environmental goals. — Explanation: Catch limits may reduce income now but aim to help fish populations recover.

GED-SOC3-011 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Oversight of the executive branch — Explanation: Congressional hearings and document requests are ways Congress oversees executive agencies.

GED-SOC3-012 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: Railroad mileage increased substantially between 1860 and 1900. — Explanation: Railroad miles rose from 1,800 to 12,600.

GED-SOC3-013 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Apportioning representation in the House — Explanation: Census results are used to assign House seats among the states.

GED-SOC3-014 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: The opportunity to produce scooters with those same resources — Explanation: Opportunity cost is the next-best alternative given up when a choice is made.

GED-SOC3-015 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Checks and balances — Explanation: The president nominates justices, but the Senate checks that power through confirmation.

GED-SOC3-016 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: The war effort changed labor patterns in the United States. | The federal government encouraged civilian participation in the war effort. — Explanation: The description shows changes in industrial labor and federal efforts to involve civilians through bonds and conservation.

GED-SOC3-017 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Forest — Explanation: Forest covers 38%, the largest share in the table.

GED-SOC3-018 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Freedom of the press and political expression — Explanation: The editorial criticizes government policy and urges political action, both connected to First Amendment freedoms.

GED-SOC3-019 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: The number of unemployed workers decreased each year. — Explanation: The number fell from 9,600 to 7,800 to 6,500.

GED-SOC3-020 — Correct: D1=Electoral College; D2=total number of senators and representatives — Correct Answer: D1=Electoral College; D2=total number of senators and representatives — Explanation: The Electoral College formally selects the president, and a state's electors generally equal its senators plus representatives.

GED-SOC3-021 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: 14 — Explanation: Electoral votes equal House representatives plus senators, so $12 + 2 = 14$.

GED-SOC3-022 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Whether the United States should remain isolated or take a more active role in world affairs — Explanation: Source A favors staying out of foreign wars, while Source B supports a more active response to overseas threats.

GED-SOC3-023 — Correct: 20 — Tolerance: exact — Correct Answer: 20 — Explanation: The increase is 500,000; 500,000 divided by 2,500,000 equals 20%.

GED-SOC3-024 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Free exercise of religion and government neutrality toward religion — Explanation: The ruling protects religious belief from government punishment based on dislike of the group's beliefs.

GED-SOC3-025 — Correct: T1=B; T2=A; T3=C — Correct Answer: T1=Enumerated powers; T2=Reserved powers; T3=Concurrent powers — Explanation: Enumerated powers are listed for the federal government, reserved powers are kept by states or the people, and concurrent powers are shared.

GED-SOC3-026 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: It helps the family plan how to use limited income. — Explanation: A budget helps people make choices about limited money.

GED-SOC3-027 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Rule of law — Explanation: Published laws, legal review, and equal procedures show that government acts under law.

GED-SOC3-028 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Limits on executive power and the importance of accountability — Explanation: The source describes investigations and disputes over presidential power and evidence.

GED-SOC3-029 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Limited direct access to maritime trade routes — Explanation: A landlocked country must rely on routes through neighboring countries to reach seaports.

GED-SOC3-030 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: 1,000 — Explanation: $240 + 180 + 310 + 270 = 1,000$.

GED-SOC3-031 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Participating in the legal process when required — Explanation: Appearing as a witness and giving truthful testimony are civic responsibilities within the legal system.

GED-SOC3-032 — Correct: A,C — Correct Answer: North and South had the same turnout rate. | West had a turnout rate of 50%. — Explanation: North is $2,400/4,000 = 60\%$ and South is $3,000/5,000 = 60\%$; West is $1,250/2,500 = 50\%$.

GED-SOC3-033 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Lawmaking procedures can slow decisions but encourage review and accountability. — Explanation: Committee debate, amendments, votes, and executive review allow multiple points of review before a bill becomes law.

GED-SOC3-034 — Correct: B — Correct Answer: 7,500 — Explanation: 11,700 minus 4,200 equals an increase of 7,500 registered voters.

GED-SOC3-035 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Government agencies must follow lawful procedures when creating regulations. — Explanation: The court stopped enforcement because the agency did not follow the required notice and comment process.